Moscow on October 20 upon Kosygin's return from a secret visit to Cairo, during which he pressed the Egyptians to agree to the cease-fire, posed an obstacle but did not change Golda's decision to go to the United States.

Tsoref sums up his research as follows:

> Only twenty-seven days passed between October 3 and October 30, but in terms of the status of the Mossad and Zamir as its leader, it felt like light-years. On October 3, a critical discussion was held on the possibility of the breakout of war, and the Mossad director was not even invited to participate. On October 30, Zamir was the senior figure in everything related to intelligence assessments in the Prime Minister's Office. There is no clearer evidence than this meeting to indicate the strengthening of the Mossad's standing in the eyes of Israeli leaders and Zamir's important role in the conduct of the Yom Kippur War and the diplomatic struggle that accompanied it. This was due both to the information he presented to the leaders and to his assessments, which were based on his extensive military experience.[4]

Wise words indeed! One more thought to finish. Wars are conducted by people. In order to properly analyze them, it is not enough to know "who's who" and "who is for and who is against." To really get to the root of things—decisions, actions, and omissions—one has to understand the historical, political, personal, and even egotistical background of each of the players that make up the "command center." None of the security experts who surrounded Ben-Gurion accepted his decision to subordinate the head of the Mossad to the prime minister! This subordination was anathema to defense ministers, directors general of the Defense Ministry, and the heads of Military Intelligence over the years. Another point is that a person's rank was measured with the help of a strange political tool—did he identify with "Ahdut Ha'avoda" (such as Tabenkin and Yigal Allon) or with Mapai (like Ben-Gurion and his political circle)? Or was he a veteran of the Palmach or of another body (the Haganah, the British army, etc.)? Whoever wants to truly understand the background of the Yom Kippur War must be aware of the fact that Dayan and Zamir had a lukewarm relationship. Why? Because historically, Zamir was considered a close friend of Yigal Allon, Dayan's greatest rival. In addition, Dayan objected to Zamir's appointment as head of the Mossad, preferring another candidate. When he took office, Zamir made it clear to Dayan that he would work directly under Golda, which Dayan did not like. The relationship was so tepid that Zamir was not even invited to discussions with Defense Minister Dayan! The head of Military Intelligence, Major General Eli Zeira, was a favorite of Moshe Dayan's, and Dayan had tapped him to be chief of staff one day. Golda, who did not possess military knowledge and experience, and had no more than a formal